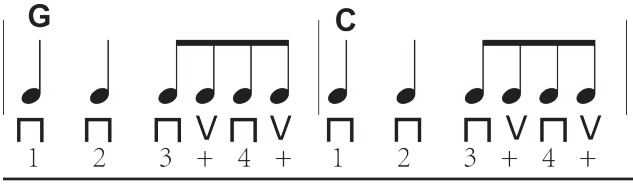
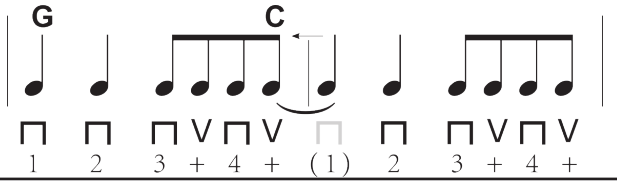
LESSON 12: SYNCOPATED CHORD CHANGES

Chord progressions can sound far more exciting when the changes occur on syncopated beats. In these examples, we won't switch chords on the "1 beat," but will instead switch early by one eighth note (on the "and of 4"). Then, we won't strum the 1 beat at all to create a bouncy syncopated feel.

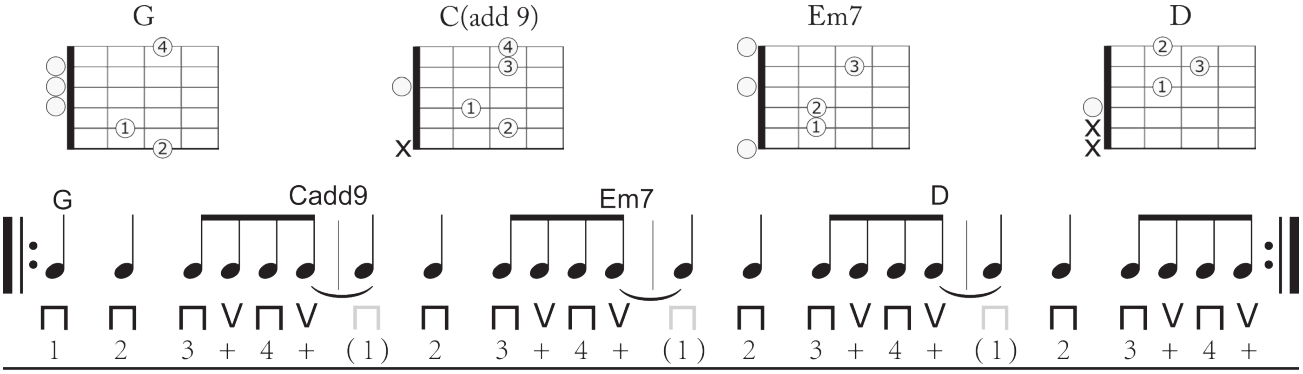
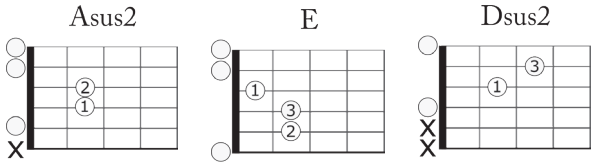
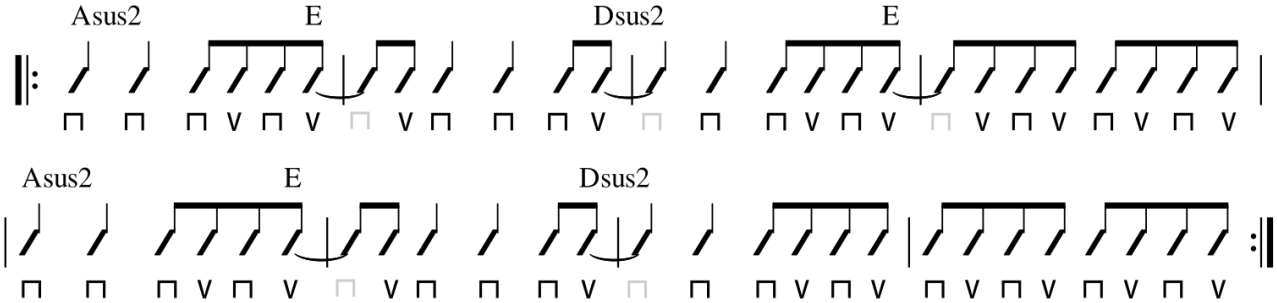
Here is a basic rhythm pattern with no syncopation present. The chord change is supposed to occur on the 1 beat.



Instead of changing on "1," we change on the eighth note before it, the "and of 4". Then we skip the 1 beat all together to create a syncopated feel.



This next four-measure exercise builds off of the previous example. The only time a chord is strummed on the 1 beat is on the first measure — the remaining changes are all syncopated.



This progression, once again, contains few "1 beats". Write in the counts yourself, and practice saying them out loud before attempting to play on your guitar.